

New Members Join In Parley

WAC Is Opening New Era Today

By ABE CHANIN
Star Sports Editor

DENVER — The eight football coaches of the newly-expanded Western Athletic Conference get together here tonight and Monday for the first time and when the two-day session of grid ballyhoo is over the picture for the 1968 championship race won't be changed.

They will still be picking Wyoming, Arizona State and newcomer University of Texas at El Paso to hook-up in a three-way battle for the WAC football title.

It's an historic meeting, this special session for football coaches and members of the press corps, because for the first time the two new member schools join in.

UTEP and Colorado State University both will be eligible for the football championship this fall as the WAC, founded with six schools in 1962, enlarges to a more profitable eight-team circuit. It's more profitable because more dues go into the conference coffers and in addition the WAC now becomes eligible for more dates on the NCAA's national and regional television schedule. The TV boost alone could mean as much as an additional \$200,000 per year to the conference and its member schools.

With the addition of UTEP and CSU the Western Conference can look to added strength. Texas-El Paso is a football powerhouse under the leadership of Bobby Dobbs, the former Army football star and coaching aide. The border school also is tremendous in basketball with the NCAA championship only a few years back.

UTEP has a great recruiter in track in Coach Wayne Vandenburg, who had a potent track and field squad last spring until Negro athletes staged a rebellion over competing against all-white Brigham Young University.

The El Paso school, which has an enrollment of some 10,000 and the most unique architecture in the league if you like Bhutanese-style buildings, is the youngest of the WAC member institutions. It was established in 1913 and got its own campus a few years later after a fire destroyed the El Paso Military Institute, where UTEP (then the Texas School of Mines) was housed.

Texas-El Paso officially is a branch of the University of Texas and its school colors of orange and white almost match that of the Longhorns at Austin. Academically UTEP, whose president is Dr. Joseph Ray, of-

New WAC Line-up

Here is a table comparing member schools of the newly-expanded Western Athletic Conference.

	ARIZONA	ASU	BYU	COLO. ST.	N. MEX.	UTEP	UTAH	WYO
Enrollment	23,000	23,000	21,000	15,600	12,500	10,000	17,800	7,400
Year Founded	1885	1885	1875	1870	1892	1913	1850	1884
No. Sports	10	10	10	10	10	8	11	12

—Stadium Seating Capacities—

Football	42,000	40,000	30,000	30,000	30,000	30,000	30,000	26,000
Basketball	3,600	4,400	10,200	9,520	14,831	8,400	6,500	11,000
Baseball	4,200	1,500	1,000	1,200	1,000	3,000	10,000	1,200
Track	30,000	4,700	30,000	13,000	20,000	12,000	20,000	600
Swimming	200	150	1,400	700	6,700	none	none	200
Gym-Wrest.	3,600	4,600	10,200	9,520	6,700	4,800	6,000	11,500
Tennis	300	150	400	150	100	200	none	200

fers 13 degrees with a range of courses from art to zoology.

George McCarty, a 1950 graduate of New Mexico State and former basketball coach there, is the UTEP athletic director. Under him football coach Dobbs has a staff of six assistants.

Don Haskins of Oklahoma State is the school's highly successful basketball coach. His recruiting, centered in the New York City area, has made UTEP a national power.

Andy Cohen, the former major leaguer, is the school's part-time baseball coach. His regular job is promoting beer sales in the El Paso area. Minor sports are still being developed by McCarty and the school does not yet have competitive teams in swimming, gymnastics or wrestling.

Colorado State University, located in farming country just east of the majestic Rocky Mountains, has an enrollment of 15,600 and has growing pains. Headed by Dr. W. E. Morgan, the school has considerable construction underway in both academic and athletic expansion. A 30,000-seat football stadium is being rushed to completion for this season and the school dedicated a new 9,520-seat basketball gymnasium last season. The school has seven colleges and is known widely for its training in veterinary medicine,

biomedical sciences and forestry.

Perry C. Moore of Maryland is the school's new athletic director and his head football coach, Mike Lude of Hillsdale, Mich., College, is highly-rated. He was on Wisconsin's list for interview on the last coaching change there. Lude has a staff of six assistants.

Colorado State has a strong basketball program led by coach Jim Williams. Don (Tuffy) Mullison is the coach of a well-rated wrestling program. Steve Johnson heads up gymnastics and Irv Ferguson is the baseball coach. Art Solow coaches a strong swimming program.

In football Colorado State plays three conference foes but friendly members of the WAC allowed the Rams to become eligible for the championship by counting games against Texas Tech and the Air Force Academy, who are not in this league.

UTEP plays everyone in the league so the WAC starts off in September with a new eight-team circuit in football.

Stewart Wins Race

OULTON PARK, England (AP) — Jackie Stewart of Scotland, driving a Matra Ford, won the 110-mile Gold Cup Formula One race Saturday by averaging 109.29 m.p.h.



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